



Galaxy S5 Zoom

Images of the upcoming Samsung Galaxy K or Galaxy S5 Zoom have leaked online. Check them out here: <http://dgit.in/GS5Zoom>

First YouTube video

It's been 9 years since YouTube's first video. Let's see how much the internet has changed since then, because of it <http://dgit.in/9yrsyt1vid>

LED Monitors

about 15 monitors for this test ranging in size from 22-inch to 27-inch and we feel they're a very healthy representation of the variety of monitors available in the market today. Also, if we've missed out a few manufacturers it's not because

we're partial, it's just that some of them declined to have any of their monitors participate in the test.

We've broken down the monitors into two categories and without any further ado, let's begin with the test.

22-INCH TO 24-INCH MONITORS

This is by far the most popular category as far as monitors are concerned and the bulk of the monitors that we received fell into this category. Interestingly, all the monitors here

boasted of a native resolution of 1080p. Most were TN panels, but there were a few VA and IPS panels thrown in as well. Moreover, they are priced between ₹9,000 to ₹22,000 which is a somewhat a sweet spot.

HOW WE TESTED

Testing monitors is quite a finicky process. All the monitors need to be calibrated to some sort of baseline (for reference) and the tools used need to be up to the task. Here's an overview of our test process.

TEST RIG:

The monitors were evaluated on a rig with the following configuration:

- CPU: Intel Core i7 3960X
- MoBo: ASRock X79 Extreme 6/GB
- RAM: Kingston 8GB @ 1600 MHz
- HDD: WD Velociraptor 600GB @ 10,000 rpm
- GPU: Nvidia GeForce GTX 770 (reference graphics card)
- PSU: Corsair HX620
- Mouse: Razer Ouroboros
- Keyboard: Corsair K95
- Sensor: DATACOLOR Spyder3Elite

INITIAL SETUP:

The setup process was as follows:

- The monitor was first setup on the test rig and then restored to factory default settings
- Monitors were then placed in sRGB mode if available, otherwise they were set to "Standard" or "Normal" mode depending on nomenclature.
- The test environment was maintained at a standard level of lighting for the duration of the test.
- All monitors were calibrated using the Spyder3Elite sensor using the sRGB target profile. Preference was given to black levels during setup, therefore the calibrated brightness levels will be lower than the maximum brightness of the display.

TEST PROCESS:

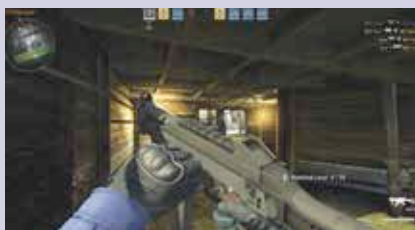
All tests were performed under controlled lighting conditions and all results were logged in an excel sheet for number crunching at a later stage.

- After calibration, the Spyder3Elite was used to measure the contrast ratio and calibrated brightness of the panel.
- Lagom.nl was used for measuring black levels, white levels and sharpness using the recommended test process (as specified by lagom.nl).
- PixPerAn was used to measure pixel persistence and refresh rate. This is a somewhat subjective test and was thus given a lower weightage than others.



The following tests were conducted to evaluate real-world performance:

- **Counter-Strike: Global Offensive:** This is a fast-paced game and was used to evaluate the refresh rate of the monitor.



- **ARMA II: OA:** A military simulation, ARMA II's "Death from Above" scenario was used to evaluate the monitor's contrast ratio.



- **Avatar:** The movie features some amazing lighting and colour effects, not to mention the fast-paced action sequences. Avatar was used to evaluate the overall movie watching experience on the monitor.



- The strength of the stand was evaluated by tapping the monitor at certain points along the bezel. The duration of the wobble was recorded and averaged over five taps.
- Ratings were also given for the ease of use of the OSD. Monitors with backlit OSD buttons and more ergonomically placed buttons received higher ratings.

FEATURES SCORE:

Every monitor was given a features score based on the various features that the monitor possessed. These include bundled cables, connectivity options, refresh rates, USB hub, etc. Each feature was given a weight based on a pre-determined scale.

FINAL SCORE:

The final score was obtained by taking the sum of features score (40 percent weightage) and the performance score (60 percent weightage).

DISCLAIMER: Owing to space constraints, the entire log-sheet with testing records couldn't be printed in this issue, but the elements necessary to make an informed decision are present in the tables. Feel free to write in to us at editor@thinkdigit.com with any questions and/or suggestions regarding our test processes.